TOOLS AND CHECKLISTS · D4

Warning Signs and Early Intervention

The one-page card: the signs, the four steps, the right question, and what to do when a resignation letter arrives.

For	Every mentor's pocket
Issue	Issue 1a (Draft for Review), October 2026: the July 2026 text set on the Provincial template

The signal is a break in his pattern, not his absolute level of attendance. A Brother who has always come four times a year is not at risk; a Brother who always came and has stopped, is. None of these signs alone is cause for alarm - a combination, or a persistent pattern, warrants action. The two highest-risk windows: the first two years (before and just after Raising) and the year after the Chair.

Watch for	Signs a member may be beginning to disengage
Attendance	Two or more consecutive meetings missed without explanation • repeatedly arriving late or leaving early • attending only Installations or social events • no longer visiting other Lodges
Participation	Reluctance to accept Lodge work or prepare for office • withdrawal from conversation and social interaction • missing LoI while holding office • distracted, disengaged or unhappy in meetings
Communication	Not responding to calls or messages • frustration, disappointment or disillusionment • repeated mentions of money or time pressure • subscription falling into arrears (the Treasurer often sees this first)

	Step	What happens
1	**Personal Mentor - informal contact**	Warm, friendly, unforced: a call, a message, a coffee. After any unexplained absence; always within seven days of a second consecutive miss. A welfare call, never a whip - he was missed, and several Brethren asked after him.
2	**Lodge Mentor involved**	If concern continues or the cause needs more than friendship: the Lodge Mentor takes an overview, considers what the Lodge can change, keeps a discreet note, and closes the loop - act, then confirm the member actually feels better.
3	**Worshipful Master's conversation**	Where the matter touches Lodge culture, office, or another member: a considered, private conversation - with the Almoner alongside for anything touching welfare.
4	**Provincial referral**	Where an impartial third party gives the best chance of keeping him - or he may thrive in a different Lodge. Contact the Provincial Grand Mentor's office. Referral is a sign of responsible mentoring, not failure.

> **The right question.** "How can we help?" - never "Why aren't you attending?" The first opens a door; the second puts a man on the defensive. Compassionate enquiry, not interrogation. Family, Work, Masonry - in that order, always: the member managing a busy life is not disengaged, and Freemasonry must fit into his life, not demand that life fit around it.

If a resignation letter arrives: tell the Lodge Mentor, the Almoner and the Secretary the same day. The Secretary acknowledges receipt only - he cannot 'accept' a resignation - and the Lodge has a sixty-day window (Rule 183) in which a resignation can be withdrawn. Roughly one resignation in three is recovered when someone takes the trouble to have the conversation. See the Retention, Retrieval and Migration Guide.

Welfare concerns - health, money, bereavement, family - belong to the Almoner: involve him at once. Relocation? Trigger the migration conversation early - see the Guide.

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